

Feature

Find out how Blockchain is going to be the next big enabler of everything.

**How did Mars cool down?**

After more than four and a half years of exploring Mars, scientists can't seem to figure how ancient Mars got so warm. <http://digit.in/liquidMars>

THE DROIDS YOU'RE LOOKING FOR

**IT'S 2017 AND YET, ROBOTS AREN'T DOING EVERYTHING FOR US —
ALTHOUGH THEY ARE GETTING PRETTY CLOSE.**



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A factory in Dongguan, China – the one belonging to Changying Precision Technology – replaced 90% of its 600 strong human workforce with robots – and soon saw a 250% rise in productivity and a 20% drop in defects. It is undeniable that we have arrived at an age where robots taking our jobs is not longer the stuff of conjecture.



REMEMBER TALOS?

To begin with, let's clear up any confusion about what constitutes a robot versus a mechanical machine. While according to some definitions early computing machines as well as mechanical clocks would technically

be robots, what we are looking at here are humanoid machines – the kind that mimic humans in purpose and shape.

In various cultures, some artificial creations have always been brought into the world by beings of mythical powers – Clay Golems, Talos from Greek mythology and more. Some of the earliest stories (since there's barely any physical evidence to credibility) and concepts date back to as far as the 4th century BC when Greek Mathematician Archytas of Tarentum proposed the design of a steam-propelled bird. But one of the first documented designs of a humanoid robot came much later in Da Vinci's notebooks from the year 1495. The designs, most likely based on his anatomical research for the Vitruvian man, were intricate and detailed a mechanical knight that could sit up, wave its arms and move its head and jaw.

The 18th century saw a lot of activity in the field of robotics. Automaton in this century were actually capable of acting, drawing, flying and even playing music – but mostly as toys or means of entertainment for the rich. Jacques de Vaucanson was a robotics pioneer of



Talos represented on an ancient coin

IMAGING: PETERSON PJ